Confusing Lands

Rules

Contents

18 cards, 1 scoring pad, 1 pencil

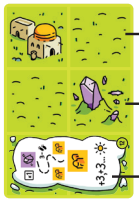
Objective

To create the landscape that scores the most points (☀) at the end of the game.

Setup

Shuffle all 18 cards (with their scoring conditions facedown) to form the deck, and place it in the center of the play area. Deal 1 card from the top of the deck to the center of the play area with its scoring condition faceup. This will be the **Shared Scoring Condition** for this game.

Card Anatomy



Cards are double-sided with 6 spaces per side. There are 7 different symbols: river, forest, mountain, village, elk, wolf, and crystal.

Each card has a scoring condition on 1 side. Each scoring condition takes up 2 spaces and has a number next to it to help locate its description in the rules.

Any space with no symbol or scoring condition is an empty space.

Gameplay

1. Deal each player 2 cards. Each player chooses 1 card to place in their landscape. (They may look at both sides.)
2. Each player adds their chosen card to their landscape. They may place it with either side faceup, with any number of 90° rotations, with the following restrictions:

The new card must cover at least 1 space already in the player's landscape. (Ignore on first turn.)

The new card cannot cover any part of a scoring condition.

Spaces in a landscape must form a grid: no partially covered spaces. Once placed, cards can't be moved.

3. Once both players have placed their chosen cards, they pass the cards they didn't want to each other, then place the new cards in their landscapes following the rules above.
4. Repeat until both players have 8 cards in their landscapes.

Game End

Once both players have 8 cards in their landscapes (and the deck has 1 card remaining in it), the game ends and players proceed to scoring.

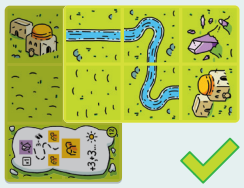
Scoring

Each player scores ☀ as directed by all of the scoring conditions in their landscape and the Shared Scoring Condition. (See Scoring Conditions on the back of the rule sheet.)
If a player has no scoring conditions in their landscape, they score 0 ☀ from the Shared Scoring Condition

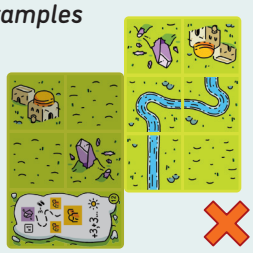
Then **each player subtracts 10☀ from their score for each scoring condition in their landscape** (not the Shared Scoring Condition).

The player with the most ☀ wins! In the event of a tie, the player with the single most valuable scoring condition wins. If there is still a tie, players share the victory.

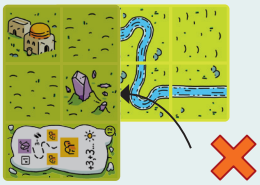
Placement Examples



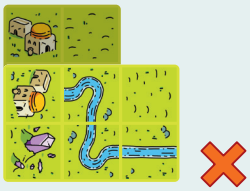
The new card covers at least 1 space without covering any scoring conditions.



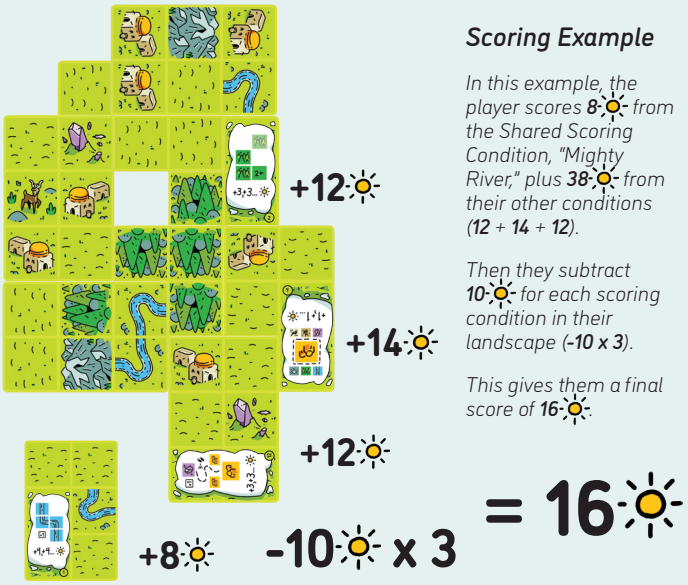
The new card doesn't cover any spaces already in the player's landscape.



The new card was tucked under an existing card.



The new card covers a scoring condition.



Scoring Example

*In this example, the player scores **8**☀ from the Shared Scoring Condition, "Mighty River," plus **38**☀ from their other conditions (**12** + **14** + **12**).*

*Then they subtract **10**☀ for each scoring condition in their landscape (**-10 x 3**).*

*This gives them a final score of **16**☀.*

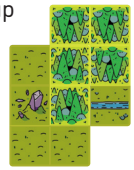
Scoring Conditions

Key Terms

Touching: The 4 orthogonal spaces around a space.

Near: The 8 orthogonal and diagonal spaces around a space.

Connected: A group of spaces where each space is **touching** at least 1 other space in the group.



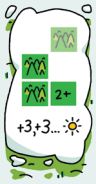
Border: Any space that touches the area outside your landscape.

Flows Into: A river space "flows into" another space if they touch on an edge that contains a river end.

Flows Past: A river space "flows past" another space if they touch on an edge that does not contain a river end.

X Spaces From:
To determine how far a space is from another space, count the shortest orthogonal path of spaces in your landscape.

1. Mighty River
Score 4 for each space in your largest group of connected river spaces that touch end to end.



2. Noble Woodlands
Score 3 for each of your forest spaces that is in a connected group of 2 or more forest spaces.

3. Barrier Range
Score 3 for each mountain space that is on the border of your landscape.

4. Thriving Villages
Each of your village spaces scores 1 for each different type of non-village symbol in spaces near it.

5. The Circle Of Life
Score 6 for each set of 1 wolf space and 1 elk space in your landscape.

6. Ancient Relics
Score 4 for each crystal space that is neither near nor in the same row/column as another crystal space.

7. Roaring Falls
Each of your river spaces scores 4 for each mountain space it flows **into**.

8. Shaded Streams
Each of your river spaces scores 4 for each forest space it flows **past**.

9. Valley Guardians
Each of your crystal spaces scores 2 for each mountain space that is exactly 4 spaces from it.

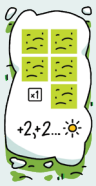
10. Fierce Hunters
Score 8 for each of your wolf spaces that is 5 or more spaces from any village spaces or other wolf spaces.

11. Forest Spirit
Score 8 for each of your elk spaces that is near 3 or more forest spaces.

12. Town Center
Choose a crystal space. Score 3 for each village space that is 3 or fewer spaces from the chosen crystal space.

13. Distant Outposts
Score 1 for each space in your longest continuous straight line of spaces (that contains no scoring conditions).

14. Close Neighbors
Score 1 for each space in your largest perfect square of spaces (that contains no scoring conditions).



15. The Great Prairie
Score 2 for each space in your largest group of connected empty spaces.

16. Land of Plenty
Score equal to the value of your least valuable other scoring condition (including the Shared Scoring Condition).

17. Tranquility
Score 1 for each village, mountain, and/or forest space in your landscape.

18. Wilderness
Score 1 for each river, crystal, wolf, and/or elk space in your landscape.

Solo Play Variant

Set up the game as normal, shuffling the deck and dealing a Shared Scoring Condition.

Deal cards only to yourself.

When you would give a card to your opponent, discard it instead.

When your opponent would give you a card, discard the top card of the deck and take the card below it.

At the end of the game, you will have only your own landscape to score. Score it as normal, then refer to the table on the right to see how you did!

- 50+ : Astounding
- 40+ : Unbelievable
- 30+ : Confusing
- 20+ : Perplexing
- 10+ : Bewildering
- 9 or less: Lost

Credits

Game Design, Art, Graphic Design: *Zak Eidsvoog*

Playtesters: *Alec Chase, Alex Cooley, Harry Lee, Ian Rickett, Madeline Ross, Joellen Sweeney*

Special thanks *to Ian, for all his help workshopping, and to Maddy, for all her support. Thanks also to everyone who downloaded and played the original print-and-play (PNP) version on itch.io!*

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